FADE IN:

EXT. SIDE OF THE ROAD - NIGHT

Run-down buildings reach for the moon. Street lamps buzz. Traffic lights shift their hues.

Detective BUI marches through the darkness, clutching a disposable cup of coffee.

Bui stops next to the open passenger-side window of a large white SUV. Inside, Detective VELEZ sings along to an upbeat song.

Velez stops after a bit and faces Bui.

VELEZ
Evening Bui, you heading over to Stagg Street?
BUI
Velez laughs it off.
Evening. Yes, I am. How on Earth did you get assigned to this case?

Velez laughs it off.

VELEZ
For your information, I busted a lot of crack heads back in vice. They promoted me to homicide.
BUI
Bui keeps walking.
Whatever you say. I'll believe it when I see it.
VELEZ
Hey,-

Bui stops.
VELEZ (CONT'D)
Why don't I give you a ride? It's
pretty chilly out here.
Bui's face scrunches up in disdain.
VELEZ (CONT'D)
Come on! For old times' sake, huh
Bui?
Bui shrugs with a sigh.

The car turns a corner.
BUI
...Why not?
Bui opens the passenger-side door and gets in. The SUV cruises off into the distance as the upbeat music resumes.
INT. VELEZ'S SUV - NIGHT
Velez has one hand on the steering wheel and the other snapping to the rhythm of the song. She's clearly enjoying herself.

Bui is not amused. She turns away from Velez and faces forward.

BUI (V.O.)

This case has only two pieces of evidence. A cheap wristwatch and a broken wine bottle. Considering how much easier it is to kill someone with broken glass than plastic, I suspect the bottle is our murder weapon.

BUI (V.O.)

The victim is an old friend of mine, Connie Cane. For her sake, I'll solve this quickly and bring her murderer to justice.

Velez's SUV rolls to a stop in front of an alleyway. Yellow tape blocks the path.

The two detectives open their doors and exit the vehicle.

EXT. ALLEYWAY - NIGHT

Officer NAMANI stands behind the tape and watches the detectives approach.

Velez ducks under the tape first and reaches out for a handshake.

VELEZ

Aye Officer Namani! Long time no see, how've you been?

Namani ignores Velez and hands Bui a large manila folder just as she comes close enough to reach it.

You're as talkative as ever,
officer.

Bui opens the folder, examines it briefly, and then hands it off to Velez.

Velez opens it too and looks inside. She scrutinizes it like she doesn't know what she's looking at.

Namani glares at them impatiently, and motions behind her to the rest of the crime scene.

Bui walks past Namani towards a chalk outline on the ground. Velez closes the folder and follows.

The chalk outline is in the shape of a sprawled out body. Bui leans down near the head. Several glass shards lie around it.

BUI

These must be from the wine bottle. It seems Connie was definitely hit in the head, either from behind or from the front.

Bui looks back to Namani as if asking for confirmation.

Namani's not looking at them. She listens to a garbled voice coming out of her walkie talkie.

After the voice fades to static, Namani lowers the walkie talkie, waves her hand dismissively at the two detectives, and walks off.

Velez looks a little surprised.

VELEZ

Well, I guess it's up to us.

Velez turns back to Bui. Bui stares at the chalk, deep in thought.

VELEZ (CONT'D)

Hello, Earth to Bui, talk to me.

Bui casts a disapproving glance in Namani's direction, then faces the ground again.

BUI

She's acting odd. Still, we need to move on.

Bui scans the chalk outline and finds a wristwatch near the torso. She picks it up and flips it over. The initials "R.N." are on the back.

BUI (CONT'D)
See these initials, Velez?
Velez leans over.
VELEZ
Yeah I see them, what of it?
BUI
Do you know anyone who has these initials?
VELEZ
Uhh, not personally, but I think we both know someone who knows someone who does.
Bui furrows her brow.
What? Who?
BUI
VELEZ
Officer Namani's grandfather has those initials.
BUI
Are you implying our suspect is related to Namani?
Velez throws her hands up.
VELEZ
Hey, it's just a theory.
BUI
We need to get Namani back here. Now.
VELEZ
Okay, calm down! We'll call the station and-
BAM! A gunshot pierces the air.
Velez's mouth hangs open as Bui collapses.
VELEZ (CONT'D)
Bui!? BUI!!
BUI
Go...go find cover you idiot.

A sniper scope watches Velez spin around and run. It moves to keep her centered.
Everything goes dark. BAM! Another gunshot.
Pause. Nothing but the distant hum of city life now.
EXT. BUSHES - NIGHT
Officer Namani rises from the bushes and turns away.
FADE TO BLACK